

SYED MUHAMMAD HAMZAH RIZVI

AI Deployment Strategist

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Applied AI engineer with 3+ years leading cross-functional workstreams — engineering, product and customer stakeholders — that turn ambiguous business problems into production AI with measurable value. Has owned up to 15 concurrent deployments spanning 10+ countries and thousands of operational endpoints, from problem discovery and POC scope through production launch and scale. Built and shipped an internal AI assistant now serving 300+ customer accounts weekly, associated with a 40% reduction in first-line ticket volume and a 55% reduction in resolution time per Jira metrics since release (tracked alongside other concurrent initiatives). Technically fluent across Python, REST APIs, LLM integration and RAG architectures, able to pressure-test technical plans against production-readiness constraints, and comfortable communicating tradeoffs on scope, risk, speed and adoption to both executive and engineering audiences.

CORE SKILLS

- **Product & Delivery Strategy:** Problem discovery, POC scope definition, success metrics and KPI design, value case development, adoption tracking, milestone and roadmap ownership, route-to-production planning.
- **Cross-Functional Leadership:** Driving execution across engineering, product, and customer teams; resolving blockers; keeping priorities and risks visible; aligning technical and executive stakeholders on tradeoffs.
- **Applied AI:** LLMs (Mistral, Llama, OpenAI models), agentic workflows, tool use, RAG, semantic search, prompt design, grounding and hallucination reduction, model evaluation, self-hosted and on-premise deployment.
- **Integration & Engineering:** Python, C++, FastAPI, REST API design and debugging, microservices, webhooks, authentication flows, system integrations, distributed-systems troubleshooting.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Software Consultant — Innovative Technology, Manchester, UK

Mar 2023 – Present

- Own the product and delivery plan for customer AI deployments end to end — from discovery workshops mapping workflows, handoffs and exceptions through POC scope, success metrics, integration approach and phased routes to production.
- Drive execution across engineering, product and customer stakeholder teams, keeping priorities clear, risks visible and technical blockers resolved through to go-live; act as escalation point for deployment-critical decisions.
- Embed with customer operations, engineering and executive stakeholders to align technical plans to business success criteria, making pragmatic tradeoffs across scope, sequencing and time-to-value.
- Own value cases and impact measurement for deployments — defining KPIs, tracking adoption signals, and presenting customer readouts and recommendations for what to build or scale next.
- Design, build and troubleshoot REST API integrations, webhooks and authentication flows connecting AI products to customer platforms, portals and external systems.
- Codify reusable delivery and implementation patterns — integration guides, API documentation and knowledge-transfer sessions — that measurably shortened each successive deployment.
- Delivered rollouts across retail, gaming and compliance-focused environments spanning thousands of operational endpoints, supporting live production use at scale.

Automation Engineer — Tripack Films Ltd., Pakistan

Mar 2020 – Sep 2021

- Developed and maintained industrial automation workflows, integrating control systems and sensors to improve reliability; diagnosed hardware and software issues in real-time operational environments.

Software Consultant — Evolligence, Pakistan

Dec 2019 – Mar 2020

- Built and supported backend application logic using structured APIs and data-driven workflows, collaborating with development teams on delivery.

SELECTED AI PROJECTS

GroundedOps — Production RAG Support Assistant — Python, FastAPI, React, ChromaDB, Ollama, Docker, DeepSeek/OpenAI/Claude APIs

- Deployed to production and now serving 300+ customer accounts weekly through a public embeddable widget and admin console; associated with a 40% reduction in first-line ticket volume and a 55% reduction in resolution time per internal Jira metrics since release (tracked alongside other concurrent initiatives, so not isolated to this tool alone).

- Built a retrieval-augmented QA assistant using hybrid retrieval (BM25 + dense embeddings), sigmoid-calibrated cross-encoder reranking and NLI-based grounding checks to reduce hallucination from locally hosted open-weight LLMs — a private, on-premise deployment pattern suited to regulated environments.
- Replaced fragile follow-up heuristics with an LLM-based Rewrite-Retrieve-Read query flow and per-session memory; built a 140+ test regression suite enabling fast, evidence-driven iteration and objective quality measurement.

Age Estimation & Demographic Analysis — *TensorFlow/Keras, EfficientNetB0, VGG16*

- Trained a hierarchical multi-task EfficientNetB0 model on 274k+ facial images (WIKI/IMDB, fine-tuned on UTKFace) with full data pipelines and evaluation tooling; achieved 87.5% gender accuracy, 88.4% coarse-age accuracy, 92.6% near-group (± 1) accuracy and 8.52-year MAE.

EDUCATION

MSc Robotics and Automation (Minor in AI) — University of Salford, UK

2021 – 2022

Graduated with Distinction. Dissertation: facial age and gender estimation using CNNs.

BEng Electrical Engineering — NUST, Pakistan

2015 – 2019

Focus: computer vision, machine learning and robotics.